



Marketing Playbook — how to get your first 100 users

Written 21 July 2026 · For Dobgim Joshua, founder

This is a practical plan, not theory. It assumes you have almost no marketing budget, that your market is Cameroon and the wider region first, and that your product is **nearly** ready — one important caveat in the next box.

Read this before spending a franc on ads. Three things are not finished: (1) the AI cannot answer yet — no OpenAI billing credit, so it falls back to offline answers; (2) nobody can pay you — Stripe will not register your country, so a payment provider is still needed; (3) reminder emails are stuck in "deferred" until the custom domain is authenticated.

Marketing before those work would waste your best asset: first impressions. A user who tries a broken AI does not come back. So this playbook has two phases — what to do **NOW** while finishing the product (all free, all valuable), and what to do **AT LAUNCH** once it works.

1. Who you are actually selling to

"Anyone with a vehicle" is not a market — it is a wish. You have two very different customers, and they need different pitches, prices, and channels.

	A. Business fleets MONEY	B. Individual owners VOLUME
Who	Transport & logistics firms, bus/taxi fleet owners, delivery businesses, breweries and distributors, hotels, NGOs, construction firms, agro companies	People with 2–5 vehicles: a family car plus a pickup, small landlords, taxi owners with a couple of cars, professionals
Their pain	A truck off the road costs money every hour. Mechanics overcharge. No records, no idea which vehicle bleeds cash. Drivers hide problems.	Surprise repair bills. Forgetting oil changes. No idea what they have spent.
What convinces them	Numbers: "this vehicle cost you 340,000 FCFA in 6 months — double the others." Cost control, not AI novelty.	Convenience and peace of mind: "never forget a service again."
Where to find them	In person, LinkedIn, transport unions, referrals from mechanics and fuel stations	WhatsApp, Facebook groups, TikTok, word of mouth

Price sensitivity	\$100/month is nothing against one avoided breakdown. Sell hard.	\$20/month $\approx$ 12,000 FCFA is a lot for an individual here. See §6 on pricing.
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Start with A. Ten business customers at \$100 is \$1,000/month. A thousand individuals on free tier is a cost. Businesses also give you the case studies that later sell to everyone else.

2. Phase NOW — do these while the product is being finished FREE

2.1 Recruit 5–10 "design partners"

Not customers — partners. Find five fleet owners you can actually reach (a relative's transport business, a church with buses, a friend's delivery service, a local hotel) and offer this deal in person:

WHAT TO SAY — IN PERSON OR ON WHATSAPP

"I've built a system that tracks vehicle maintenance and warns you before a breakdown. I'm looking for five fleet owners to use it free for six months and tell me honestly what's wrong with it. No cost, no obligation. If it saves you money, you keep using it and I'll only charge later. Can I show you on my phone for ten minutes?"

Why this matters more than any advert: they will tell you what actually breaks, what confuses them, and what wording they use for their own problems — which becomes your marketing copy. And their results become your proof.

2.2 Build a waitlist page — collect emails before you have a product

Your landing page currently sends everyone to sign up. While the AI is unfinished, add a simple "Join the waitlist" option for people who are not ready. Every email is a person you can tell about launch. I can build this for you in one session.

2.3 Start posting content now, not at launch

Audiences take weeks to build. Post twice a week from today, even with no product to sell — see §4 for the content plan and ready-made posts.

2.4 Fix the three blockers

OpenAI credit (~\$5), a payment provider, and the custom domain. Nothing else in this document matters until these are done.

3. Channels that work in this market, in priority order

3.1 WhatsApp — your single most powerful channel

Do not underestimate this. In Cameroon, WhatsApp *is* the internet for most people.

- **WhatsApp Status:** post a 20-second screen recording of the AI answering a question. Everyone in your contacts sees it. Free. Do this weekly.
- **Direct messages:** for business fleets, a personal message beats any advert. Ten well-chosen DMs are worth more than 10,000 impressions.
- **Groups:** transport associations, car-owner groups, alumni and church groups. Do not spam — share something useful (a maintenance tip) and mention the tool once.
- **WhatsApp Business account:** free, gives you a catalogue and an away message. Set it up as your support channel; people trust a WhatsApp number more than a contact form here.

3.2 In-person and referral partners — underrated, very high conversion

- **Mechanics and garages:** a mechanic who recommends you to fleet owners is worth more than any ad. Offer them a cut later (\$7, referral fees) — they already have the trust.
- **Fuel stations** with commercial accounts know every fleet owner in town.
- **Transport unions / syndicats:** one presentation to a union meeting reaches dozens of fleet owners at once. Ask to speak for ten minutes.
- **Driving schools and insurance brokers:** adjacent, trusted, and they meet vehicle owners daily.

3.3 Facebook — where the buyers already gather

Search for and join: car buy/sell groups, "Cameroon Car Owners", transport and logistics groups, mechanic groups, town-specific business groups. Post value, not adverts. A page for Fleet Wise AI costs nothing and makes you look real.

3.4 TikTok — cheapest reach available right now

Short, fast videos of the AI doing something surprising perform extremely well and cost nothing. "I asked my AI which of my cars is wasting my money" is a strong hook. Same clips work as Facebook Reels and WhatsApp Status — film once, post three times.

3.5 LinkedIn — for the business customers with money

Search job titles: fleet manager, transport manager, logistics manager, operations manager, in Cameroon and neighbouring countries. Connect, then send a short note (\$5 has the template). This is slow but each win is worth \$100/month.

3.6 Paid ads — last, not first

Do not run ads until (a) the product works, and (b) you have at least one real customer story. Then spend small: 5,000–10,000 FCFA on a Facebook ad targeting business owners, and judge by sign-ups, not likes.

4. Content plan — what to actually post

Four repeating themes. Two posts a week is enough if they are consistent.

Theme	Purpose	Example
The cost of neglect	Create urgency	"A 15,000 FCFA oil change skipped becomes a 400,000 FCFA engine. Here's the maths."
Show the AI	Prove it is real	Screen recording: typing "which vehicle costs me the most?" and the answer appearing
Free maintenance advice	Build trust and reach	"Three signs your brakes are going, before they fail"
Customer results	Convert	"Kumba Express found one truck was costing double the rest. They changed mechanic."

Ready-to-post copy — use these as written

WHATSAPP STATUS / FACEBOOK — PROBLEM HOOK

Your car doesn't break down suddenly.
It breaks down slowly — and then all at once, on the road, at the worst time.

The oil change you skipped in March. The brake noise you ignored in May.

I built Fleet Wise AI so you never have to remember. It watches your vehicles and tells you what's coming — before it costs you.

Free to try 🖱️ [your link]

FACEBOOK / LINKEDIN — FOR FLEET OWNERS

If you run more than three vehicles and you don't know which one is costing you the most money, you are losing money right now — you just can't see it yet.

Fleet Wise AI keeps every service record in one place and tells you, in plain language:

- which vehicle is due for service
- which one is costing you double the others
- which repairs keep coming back (usually a sign of a bad repair, not a bad vehicle)

Built here, for fleets here. Try it free: [your link]

TIKTOK / REELS — SCRIPT FOR A 20-SECOND CLIP

[Screen recording of the app]

Text on screen: "I asked my AI which of my vehicles wastes the most money..."

[Type the question, answer appears naming a vehicle and an amount]

Text: "It read 6 months of my own service records."

Text: "Fleet Wise AI — free to try."

MAINTENANCE TIP POST — BUILD TRUST, NO SELLING

Three things that quietly destroy engines:

1. Old oil — it stops lubricating long before it looks dirty
2. A blocked air filter — your engine runs rich and burns more fuel
3. Ignoring a small coolant leak — until the head gasket goes

None of these are expensive to fix. All of them are expensive to ignore.

5. Outreach templates

WHATSAPP / LINKEDIN MESSAGE TO A FLEET OWNER OR MANAGER

Good morning [Name] — I'm Joshua, I build software here in Cameroon.

I've made a tool that tracks vehicle maintenance for fleets and warns you by email a week before each service is due, so vehicles don't break down unexpectedly. It also shows which vehicles are costing you the most.

I'm giving it free to a few fleet owners in exchange for honest feedback. Would you like a 10-minute look? I can come to you or show you on WhatsApp.

MESSAGE TO A MECHANIC OR GARAGE OWNER (REFERRAL PARTNER)

Hello [Name] — I built an app that reminds vehicle owners when their service is due. When it tells someone "your brakes are due", I want to be able to send them to a garage I trust.

Can we talk about listing your garage? Nothing to pay — you'd just receive customers who already know what work they need.

6. Pricing for this market — an honest correction

Your current tiers are \$0 / \$20 / \$100 per month. For business fleets in Cameroon, \$100 (≈60,000 FCFA) is defensible — one avoided breakdown pays for a year. But **\$20/month for an individual car owner is mispriced for this market**; it is roughly 12,000 FCFA, more than many people spend on airtime and data combined.

Recommendation: add a local individual tier — something like **2,500–5,000 FCFA/month** (≈\$4–8), or a yearly price that feels like one service visit. Keep \$20 and \$100 for international and business customers. The product costs you almost nothing per user (about \$0.05/month in AI tokens for a free user), so a cheap local tier is still profitable and it is how you get volume.

Also: whatever provider we use for payments must accept **MTN Mobile Money and Orange Money**. Card-only checkout will lose most of your local market regardless of price.

7. Growth levers once you have customers

- **Referral fee for mechanics/garages** — they send you fleet owners, you pay per paying customer. Aligns your best-connected allies with your revenue.

- **Free month for a referral** — existing customer brings another, both get a month. Cheapest acquisition there is.
- **The monthly PDF report** — you already have the technology to generate branded PDFs. A monthly "your fleet cost report" emailed to business customers is the kind of thing they forward to their boss, which sells for you.
- **Case study per industry** — one transport company, one hotel, one NGO. Each becomes the pitch for every other company in that industry.

8. What to measure

Ignore likes and followers. Track only these, weekly, in a notebook if necessary:

Number	Why it matters
Sign-ups	Is the message working?
How many added at least one vehicle	Did they actually start? If sign-ups are high and this is low, your onboarding is the problem.
How many asked the AI a question	Did they reach the valuable part?
How many came back a week later	The only honest measure of whether the product is useful
Paying customers	The only measure of a business

9. The first 30 days — a concrete plan

Week	Do this
1	Finish the three blockers (AI credit, payments, domain). Film the demo video (separate script document). Set up WhatsApp Business, a Facebook page, and a TikTok account.
2	Approach 10 fleet owners in person or by WhatsApp for the design-partner offer. Aim for 5 yes. Post the demo video on Status, Facebook, TikTok.
3	Sit with each design partner while they add their vehicles — watch where they get stuck, fix it. Post twice: one maintenance tip, one AI demo.
4	Ask your best design partner for a testimonial and a number ("we found X"). Turn it into a post and a case study. Approach 10 more fleets, now with proof.

Fleet Wise AI Marketing Playbook — 21 July 2026. Pair this with the Video Script document. Revisit after your first ten users; their words are better marketing copy than anything written in advance.